DOUSING HOME FIRES

National security and elections in Kashmir remain unfinished business, even if coalition compulsions slow the momentum on UCC, CAA, NRC

By PRADIP R. SAGAR

AMIT SHAH, *64* | BJP
Minister of Home Affairs

↘ **A true Gujarati** Born to a Gujarati Hindu Bania family in Mehsana, Shah did his schooling in his home town and a B.Sc. in biochemistry from Ahmedabad

↘ **The political baptism** He began his career with RSS student wing ABVP, reportedly at the behest of Narendra Modi, who was then an RSS pracharak. Their inalienable bond was forged in those days. Sarkhej MLA four times (1995-2007), Shah shifted to Naranpura in 2008, before moving Centre stage with Modi in 2014

↘ **BJP's Chanakya** Taking a break from electoral politics, Shah helmed the party in 2014, making it a political juggernaut. In 2019, he entered Parliament via Gandhinagar, becoming HM in Modi 2.0, a role he's reprising

Ministers of State

NITYANAND RAI, *58* | BJP



↘ **Shah's man** The party's Yadav face in Bihar, the Ujiarpur MP has long enjoyed the HM's confidence. Perhaps why he returns as MoS after a stint in the last Modi government

BANDI SANJAY KUMAR, *53* | BJP



↘ **Telangana strongman** Now two-time Karimnagar MP, this Hindutva cheerleader finds a place in Shah's ministry while remaining BJP national general secretary

With a recent spate of terror attacks in Jammu, radicals gaining ground in Punjab after electoral wins for two of them, India is far from rid of terrorism. The wounds of the violence in Manipur remain raw, and while left-wing extremism may have been pushed further inland, it has been by no means eliminated. Besides, there is the unfinished business of the last term—roll-out of the Uniform Civil Code, Citizenship Amendment Act and the National Register of Citizens—though coalition dharma may put these on the back burner. New laws, including the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, replacing the Indian Penal Code, Criminal Procedure Code and the Indian Evidence Act, also need implementation. Then there is the national census, a project that is already three years behind schedule, and may now see a demand for a castewise count. The Women's Reservation Bill is another pending promise that should ideally come to fruition this term. But not before a delimitation exercise. There is plenty then to occupy the home minister and his team. ■

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

BORDER SECURITY
Given India's sensitive borders with China and Pakistan, border infrastructure needs to be fortified, either